Why It Matters, and the Ascension

1 Corinthians 15 · Romans 4:25 · Acts 1:1–11 · Luke 24:50–53

The big idea: The resurrection is God's verdict that Christ's payment was enough. It defeats death, and it is the firstfruits of the resurrection of all who belong to him. Then Jesus ascended bodily, and he reigns now at God's right hand until he comes again.

Before you meet: Read

1 Corinthians 15:12–26 | 1 Corinthians 15:50–58 | Acts 1:6–11

Open (5 minutes)

What do you think happens when we die? Where did that idea come from?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"Who was delivered up for our trespasses and raised for our _____." *(Romans 4:25)*

"But in fact Christ has been raised from the dead, the _____ of those who have fallen asleep." *(1 Corinthians 15:20)*

"This Jesus, who was taken up from you into heaven, will _____ in the same way as you saw him go into heaven." *(Acts 1:11)*

Discuss

1. Paul says if Christ has not been raised, our faith is futile. Why is the resurrection so central? *1 Corinthians 15:14–20*

2. The disciples returned from the ascension with great joy. Why would Jesus leaving make them joyful? *Luke 24:50–53; John 16:7*

3. Jesus asked Martha, Do you believe this? How would you answer him today? *John 11:25–26; Romans 10:9*

Memory verse

"And behold, I am with you always, to the end of the age."

Matthew 28:20

Pray

Praise the risen Lord who holds the keys of death. Thank him that his resurrection proves his payment was enough. If you belong to him, bring one specific need to him as your interceding High Priest, and thank him that he is with you always.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 44

Why It Matters, and the Ascension

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read 1 Corinthians 15:12–26 and Acts 1:6–11 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Acts 1–2).

Main points to land

1. The resurrection is God's verdict that Christ's payment was enough; all joined to him by faith share that verdict (Romans 4:25; 1 Corinthians 15:17).
2. Christ's resurrection defeats death and is the firstfruits of the resurrection of all who belong to him (1 Corinthians 15:20, 42–44, 55; Hebrews 2:14–15).
3. Jesus ascended bodily and now reigns, intercedes, sends the Spirit, prepares a place, and will come again (Ephesians 1:20–22; Hebrews 7:25; Acts 1:11).

Core doctrine to teach

The Resurrection and Ascension CORE DOCTRINE 22 OF 26

Jesus rose bodily from the dead on the third day. He ascended into heaven in that same body and now reigns at the Father's right hand. His resurrection is God's seal on his finished work and the promise that all who belong to him will rise too. *1 Corinthians 15:3–8, 20; Acts 1:9–11; Romans 4:25; Ephesians 1:20–22*

Answer key (Observe)

1. justification
2. firstfruits
3. come

Questions people will ask

Where is Jesus now, and is he still human?

He ascended bodily and reigns at God's right hand as a real man, in the same body, now glorified (Acts 1:9–11; WSC 28). He intercedes for his people (Hebrews 7:25) and is with us by his Spirit (Matthew 28:20).

Closing prayer

Risen Lord Jesus, you are the resurrection and the life. Thank you that you broke the power of death, that your rising proves your payment was enough, and that you reign at the Father's right hand. Bring failures back as you brought back Peter. Give us faith without seeing, and the hope of a resurrection like yours. Amen.